

DAVID TENCH

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., U. of Massachusetts, Amherst, Dept. of Computer Science **August 2020**

Research Areas: Algorithms (randomized, approximation, graph, streaming), systems applications

Dissertation: “Algorithms for Massive, Expensive, or Otherwise Inconvenient Graphs”

M.S., U. of Massachusetts, Amherst, Dept. of Computer Science

February 2018

Thesis: “MESH: Compacting Memory Management for C/C++ Applications”

B.S., Lehigh University, Department of Mathematics

May 2013

EMPLOYMENT & AFFILIATIONS

Lawrence Berkeley National Lab, Grace Hopper Postdoctoral Fellow **2023 - present**

Rutgers University, Postdoctoral Associate (NSF Computing Innovation Fellow) **2021 - 2023**

University of Massachusetts Amherst, Research Assistant **2014 - 2020**

Lehigh University, President’s Scholar **2014**

Lehigh University, South Mountain College Undergraduate Researcher **Summer 2013**

Lehigh University, TRAC (Technology, Research, and Communication) Fellow **2011 - 2013**

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I build systems that increase the scale at which we can tackle fundamental computational problems. I develop memory-hierarchy-aware algorithms for handling enormous datasets with limited space with a focus on overcoming the practical limitations of the theoretical state-of-the-art. Solving these limitations requires new algorithmic insights and careful engineering, but the reward is massively scalable systems.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Hybrid-Sketching Methods for Dynamic Connectivity on Sparse Graphs Quinten De Man, Gilvir Gill, Michael A. Bender, Laxman Dhulipala, David Tench. In *ACM Special Interest Group on Management of Data (SIGMOD) 2027*. Huntington Beach, California. June 2027.

Mitigating False Positives in Filters: To Adapt or to Cache? Mo, Tianchi and Bender, Michael A and Das, Rathish and Farach-Colton, Martin and Tench, David. In *ACM Transactions on Database Systems (TODS)*. 2025.

The Case for External Graph Sketching. Michael A. Bender, Martín Farach-Colton, Riko Jacob, Hanna Komlós, David Tench, and Evan T. West. In *Proceedings of the Conference on Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2025*. Montreal, Canada. July 2025.

Exploring the Landscape of Distributed Graph Sketching. David Tench, Evan West, Kenny Zhang, Michael Bender, Daniel Delayo, Martin Farach-Colton, Gilvir Gill, Tyler Seip, Victor Zhang. In *SIAM Symposium on Algorithm Engineering and Experiments (ALENEX) 2025*. New Orleans, LA. January 2025. (Accept rate 34%).

Adaptive Quotient Filters Richard Wen, Hunter McCoy, David Tench, Guido Tagliavini, Michael A Bender, Alex Conway, Martin Farach-Colton, Rob Johnson, Prashant Pandey. In *ACM Special Interest Group on Management of Data (SIGMOD) 2025*. Berlin, Germany. June 2025. (Round 1 accept rate 17%). **(14 citations)**

GraphZeppelin: How to Find Connected Components (Even When Graphs Are Dense, Dynamic, and Massive) David Tench, Evan West, Victor Zhang, Michael A Bender, Abiyaz Chowdhury, Daniel Delayo, J Ahmed Dellas, Martín Farach-Colton, Tyler Seip, Kenny Zhang. In *ACM Transactions on Database Systems (TODS)* 2023.

GraphZeppelin: Storage-Friendly Sketching for Connected Components on Dynamic Graph Streams. David Tench, Evan West, Victor Zhang, Michael A Bender, Abiyaz Chowdhury, J Ahmed Dellas, Martin Farach-Colton, Tyler Seip, Kenny Zhang. In *ACM Special Interest Group on Management of Data (SIGMOD)* 2022. Philadelphia, PA. June 2022. (Accept rate 29.3%) (**12 citations**)

PredictRoute: A Network Path Prediction Toolkit. Rachee Singh, David Tench, Phillipa Gill, Andrew McGregor. In *ACM Special Interest Group on Measurement and Evaluation (SIGMETRICS)* 2021. Beijing, China. June 2021. Also appears in *Proceedings of the ACM on Measurement and Analysis of Computing Systems (POMACS)* 2021. (Accept rate 17%) (**20 citations**)

Maximum Coverage in the Data Stream Model: Parameterized and Generalized. Andrew McGregor, David Tench, Hoa Vu. In *International Conference on Database Theory (ICDT)* 2021. Nicosia, Cyprus. March 2021. (Accept rate 31.9%) (**11 citations**)

Mitigating False Positives in Filters: to Adapt or to Cache? Michael Bender, Ratish Das, Martín Farach-Colton, Tianchi Mo, David Tench, Yung Ping Wang. In *SIAM Symposium on Algorithmic Principles of Computer Systems (APOCS)* 2021. Alexandria, VA (remote). January 2021. (**9 citations**)

MESH: Compacting Memory Management for Unmanaged Languages. Bobby Powers, David Tench, Emery Berger, Andrew McGregor. In *ACM Programming Languages Design and Implementation (PLDI)* 2019. Phoenix, AZ. June 2019. (Accept rate 27%) (**45 citations**)

Vertex & Hyperedge Connectivity in Graph Streams. Sudipto Guha, Andrew McGregor, David Tench. In *ACM Principles of Database Systems (PODS)* 2015. Melbourne, Australia. June 2015. (Accept rate 25%) (**104 citations**)

Densest Subgraph in Dynamic Graph Streams. Andrew McGregor, David Tench, Sofya Vorotnikova, Hoa Vu. In *Mathematical Foundations of Computer Science (MFCS)* 2015. Milan, Italy. August 2015. (Accept rate 35%) (**130 citations**)

GRANTS AWARDED

Adventures in Flatland: Algorithms for Modern Memories. June 2021 - June 2023.
Senior Scientist. NSF Medium Collaborative Research grant; Award #2106827.

AWARDS

Grace Hopper Postdoctoral Fellowship , Lawrence Berkeley National Lab	2023 - 2025
CRA/CCC/NSF Computing Innovation Fellowship	2021 - 2023
President's Scholarship , Lehigh University	2014
Lemon Prize for Undergraduate Research , Eckardt Honors Society, Lehigh University	2013
TRAC Fellowship & Mentor Fellowship , Lehigh University	2011, 2013
Williams Writing Prize , Lehigh University	2011
Dean's List , Lehigh University	2009 - 2013

PRESENTATIONS

The Case for External Graph Sketching Jul 2025
SIAM Conference on Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2025. Montreal, Canada.

Streaming Spectral Sparsification for Protein Family Identification Jul 2025
SIAM Conference on Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2025. Montreal, Canada.

Adaptive Quotient Filters	Feb 2025
Postdoc Symposium speaker, Lawrence Berkeley National Lab. Berkeley, CA.	
Exploring the Landscape of Distributed Graph Sketching	Jan 2025
SIAM ALLENEX25: Symposium on Algorithm Engineering and Experiments. New Orleans, LA.	
External Graph Sketching	July 2024
SIAM DM 2024: Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms. Spokane, WA.	
Dynamic Connectivity Sketching	Feb 2024
Postdoc Symposium speaker, Lawrence Berkeley National Lab. Berkeley, CA.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Sept 2023
Invited talk. University of Utah. Salt Lake City, UT.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	April 2023
Google NYC Algorithms Seminar. New York City, NY.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Feb 2023
Lawrence Berkeley National Lab. Berkeley, CA (virtual).	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Feb 2023
SIAM CSE 2023: Emerging Techniques in Scalable Graph Processing. Amsterdam, Netherlands.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Feb 2023
Dagstuhl 23071: Big Data Algorithms from Theory to Practice. Wadern, Germany.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Nov 2022
Dagstuhl 22461: Dynamic Graph Algorithms. Wadern, Germany.	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Sept 2022
Invited talk for MIT Fast Code Seminar. Cambridge, MA (virtual).	
Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Sept 2022
Workshop for Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2022. Aussois, France.	
GraphZeppelin	Jun 2022
ACM Special Interest Group on Management of Data (SIGMOD) 2022. Philadelphia, PA.	
Semi-Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Jan 2022
Invited talk for Algorithmic Principles of Computer Systems (APOCS) 2022. Alexandria, VA (virtual).	
Semi-Streaming Dynamic Connectivity: To Infinity and Beyond	Nov 2021
Invited talk Rutgers University Theory Seminar. New Brunswick, NJ (virtual).	
Maximum Coverage in the Data Stream Model, Parameterized & Generalized	March 2021
International Conference on Database Theory (ICDT) 2021. Nicosia, Cyprus (virtual).	
Meshing: A Theoretical Approach to “Impossible” Memory Management	March 2017
NSF “Algorithms in the Field” PI meeting. Arlington, VA.	
Densest Subgraph in Dynamic Graph Streams	Aug 2015
2015 Mathematical Foundations of Computer Science conference. Milan, Italy.	

TEACHING

Stony Brook University	Instructor	Spring 2021
Course: Algorithms Reading Group Seminar		
Notes: Lectured on graph streaming & reconstruction methods. Led student discussions on open problems in graph algorithms.		

University of Massachusetts Amherst Teaching Assistant & Lecturer 2017 - 2019
Courses: Advanced Algorithms (Fall 2018 & Fall 2019), Algorithms for Data Science (Spring 2018), Artificial Intelligence (Spring 2017), Reasoning Under Uncertainty (Fall 2017)
Notes: Gave guest lectures, held office hours, designed & graded assignments, led discussion sections for listed courses at the undergraduate, Masters, and PhD levels.

Lehigh University Head Co-Instructor Fall 2013
Course: The TRAC Fellows Seminar
Notes: A course on research methods, educational technology, writing and communication pedagogy.

MENTORING

Mentor to 2 Summer PhD Interns Berkeley Lab, summer 2024
Mentor to 9 Grad, 8 Undergrad Students UC Davis, Stony Brook & Rutgers, 2020 - present
Master's Thesis Defense Committee Member Stony Brook, 2021
PhD Student Peer Mentor UMass, Fall 2019
Mentor to an REU Student UMass, Summer 2017
TRAC Fellow & Mentor Fellow Lehigh, Fall 2011 - Spring 2014

SERVICE

Program Committee Member 2025
For SIAM Symposium on Algorithm Engineering and Experiments (ALENEX) 2026.

Program Committee Member 2025
For SIAM Conference on Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2025.

Program Committee Member 2023
For European Symposium on Algorithms (ESA) 2023.

Program Committee Member 2023
For Symposium on Parallel Algorithms and Architectures (SPAA) 2023.

Program Committee Member 2021
For SIAM Conference on Applied and Computational Discrete Algorithms (ACDA) 2021.

UMass CS Graduate Representative 2018
Advocated for grad students in faculty meetings, interviewed 40 candidates for faculty positions.

UMass CICS student-run diversity and inclusion event organizer 2018
Organized student programs to discuss gendered harassment in STEM workplaces.

Peer Reviewer 2015 - present
For DISC 2025, ICPP 2024, Algorithmica 2024, SODA 2024, ESA 2021, ICPP 2021, MFCS 2021, PODC 2020, SODA 2020, FOCS 2019, SODA 2019, STACS 2018, SODA 2018, WSDM 2016, and STOC 2015.